

MATTHANRAHANEDIT

Planning and executing massive events like concert tours is a specialised business. There's a million things to take care of, and one of the guys who achieves these things is Matt Hanrahan, a giant in the music business. Our Amsterdam correspondent, Big Frankie, caught up with Matt while he was on a recent visit to Amsterdam.

We are here for Travel Radio. We are in Amsterdam in the famous Six Dragons. That's an area in the Jordaan in Amsterdam.

And I'm here with a guy I know for many years, but I'm really honoured to meet him again here in Amsterdam. Please introduce yourself, sir. What's up, Frankie? I love you, man.

It's good to be back here in Amsterdam. My name is Matt Hanrahan. I've been a pleasure to thank you forever, and I'm so psyched to be here.

I haven't been back to Amsterdam since COVID 2019, like six years now, so it's good to be back here. Please tell the listeners what's your experience with music? What are you doing? Introduce yourself, please. Sure.

I've been very fortunate to be touring around the world for decades now, many decades with, you know, the Rolling Stones and many other bands around. You know, I've been to every state in America. I've been to, like, 40, 50 countries around the world.

I've been backstage, you know, with some of my heroes and worked with some of the greatest rock and roll bands on the biggest tours and festivals ever. You are organising shows as well? Absolutely, yeah. Whenever I can, I try to give back.

So I've been lucky enough to work with, you know, the Beast Life Festival in the US. I got to produce last year. The Rock for Responders was a direct give back to all the firemen and all the first responders in L.A. fires.

And I've been working in concerts for my whole career, some way or another. Wow. This programme goes also to Australia Radio.

And please tell me something about AC-Easy. Sure. AC-Easy, the greatest rock band ever.

I mean, one of my favourite bands you could ever imagine. I've been lucky enough to work. Australia, many times I've been to, you know, Sydney and Melbourne and Brisbane and, you know, Perth, Perth, the end of the year.

And I've been up scuba diving and, you know, the Cairns. And I love it. That's one of my favourite places to go.

Some of the greatest bands, including Akadaka, as they call them down there, AC-DC. I've been around AC-DC, you know, for a bunch of times. I've been through what Brian Johnson has been seeing at the stadium, showing them so psyched that they're back touring right now.

What did you do with the bands? Did you organise shows? I have organised countless concerts, be they club shows, be they theatre shows, arena shows. I've even worked on festivals, you name it. It's been a fortunate part of my life, the biggest touring festivals in the world.

Where do you live now? Right now I live in LA. I live in Woodland Hills, which is a suburb of Los Angeles. I'm still a New Yorker at heart.

That's the town that made me. You know, New York City is where I grew up. But I'm an Angelino these days.

What are your favourite bands all the time? I mean, I think the greatest bands of all time are, you know, The Rolling Stones and AC-DC. I love those guys more than anything. I think I can go on.

I love Van Halen. I love lots of guitar driven rock and roll. But I also love, you know, Bob Marley and reggae and jazz and everything.

That's like good music. It could be any genre. Wow, you've been at least a week in Amsterdam.

What's your opinion now about Amsterdam? Well, I think Amsterdam may be the city that I've been to more than any other city in the world. Because it's, you know, as they say, the gateway to Europe. So many times I've been on my way somewhere or on my way back from somewhere else.

And I've cut through Amsterdam for, you know, anywhere from 24 hours to, in this case, a couple of weeks. It's one of the greatest cities in the entire world. Just fantastic place to look at, to get around.

You know, of course, this is what Big Frankie is. So where else do you want to be? Great music. Yeah.

And I've been, some of the greatest concerts I've been, have been here at the arenas and the festivals. It's wonderful. I love Amsterdam.

And please, I hope you did a concert on a ship in America. Can you tell shortly about this? Yeah. Well, you know, unfortunately, earlier this year, LA suffered, I think, the worst ever fires ever you could ever imagine.

My whole life in LA, we've seen fires happen every year up in the woods. But never right down, you know, right in town, the Pacific Palisades, the Pasadena, all these places. So I was fortunate enough to put together a benefit concert called Rock for Responders.

Well, we got some of the greatest musicians, Hall of Famers, like Sammy Hagar, you know, Rishi Sambora, you know, Robin Zander. All these great people came together, donated their time to give these hardworking first responders a night off, a night of great entertainment. And of course, we raised awareness and funds for all these, you know, great people and nonprofits to support all those things.

Last question, Matt, is it still future for Rock music? Yeah, I think so. I think Rock is maybe doing better now than it's been ever before. I think if you look at some of the festivals and the numbers, they're killing.

You know, sure, there's new genres and more distractions than ever before. But I think that the Rock festivals are killing it. I think that you look at, you know, Danny Wimmer and you look at, you know, Andy Copping in the UK, you know, Download Festival, all these places.

They're selling out in advance some years before they even released the festival lineup. So here's to that. Here's to Rock.

Thank you. And in the end, is it about the money or about the passion? It's only ever been about the passion. The money is nice.

We'll take it. You got to leave with your heart, leave with your soul. The passion is worth time.

Thank you, Matt, for this interview. Really. Thank you.

Have a great time in Amsterdam. And we all hope to see you on the road again, wherever in the world. Thank you, Frankie.